

# MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Upper Elementary | Unit 6

## Compare Related Words



Today I am learning to compare **related words** by finding the base word and meaning they share.

### 1 Learn the Idea

Related words belong to the same **word family** when they share a base word and a connected meaning. Prefixes and suffixes can change the word, but the family connection remains.

**help** helper • helpful      **care** careful • careless  
**happy** happier • happiness      **play** player • playful

### 2 Build the Family

Add another related word, then explain the shared idea.

| Base word | One family word | Another family word | Shared idea |
|-----------|-----------------|---------------------|-------------|
| help      | helpful         | _____               | _____       |
| care      | careless        | _____               | _____       |
| happy     | happiness       | _____               | _____       |
| play      | player          | _____               | _____       |
| teach     | teacher         | _____               | _____       |

### 3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

On Saturday, Aria joined a neighbourhood games afternoon. She was an older **player**, but she still had a **playful** sense of humour and made the younger children laugh. A **helpful** parent showed everyone where to put their bags, while another **helper** organised the teams. Aria **carefully** carried the equipment across the oval. One **careless** throw sent a beanbag under a bench, so she stopped to pick it up. A younger child became **unhappy** when his tower fell, but Aria helped him rebuild it. Soon he was playing **happily** again, and his **happiness** spread to the rest of the group. Aria noticed that player and playful were connected to **play**, helpful and helper to **help**, carefully and careless to **care**, and unhappy and happiness to **happy**.



Highlight related words. Use the **same colour** for words from the same family.

### 4 Word Detective

Choose one family word from the passage and investigate how it is related to other words.

- Write one family word from the passage.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- What base word does it come from?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Write another word from the same family.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- How are the meanings of the words connected?  
\_\_\_\_\_

### 5 Sort the Families

Sort the words into the correct word family.

helpful    helpless    player    replay    careless    carefully

help family

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

play family

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

care family

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

### 6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

- The words \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_ share the base \_\_\_\_\_.
- Use another word from that **family** in a sentence.  
\_\_\_\_\_



#### Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Finds the base word in related words
- ☐ Groups words into word families
- ☐ Explains how family words share meaning
- ☐ Uses a related word in a sentence



#### Capture idea:

Find two related words in a book or around the home. Underline the **shared base** and explain how their meanings connect.